



GOOD THINGS HAPPEN

Newsletter of Minnehaha United Methodist Church

We seek, we serve, we celebrate.

March

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Good Things Happen
is the newsletter of
Minnehaha United Methodist Church,
published each month.

The deadline for April is
March 17

Contributions may be brought to the
office or emailed to:
office@minnehaha.org
3701 East 50th Street
Minneapolis, MN 55417

About Us:

Minnehaha United Methodist Church is a thriving multi-generational, multicultural Christian community devoted to social justice and personal spiritual growth. The congregation is both mission- and worship-focused. In addition to its worship, education, and social activities, the church supports local mission activities, including a food shelf and a monthly food distribution program. The church also supports a variety of national and international relief, education, and development projects.

A Reconciling Congregation:

Minnehaha United Methodist Church opens our doors to all God's people. We will strive to offer unconditional love and acceptance to all persons, regardless of race, sexual orientation or faith history. We work to eliminate prejudice and discriminatory practices within ourselves and within our community. -adopted 2006

Our Mission:

We seek, we serve, we celebrate, we carry our Christian faith into our community and the world. We provide a caring gathering place to worship God and to grow spiritually. -reconfirmed 2011

March

SUNDAY WORSHIP

9:00 am Worship with organ and choir.

10:00 am Education and Fellowship

11:00 am Worship with band and vocals.

Infant and toddler care available all morning.

Minnehaha Happenings in March

Sun	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat
	March is FoodShare Month 49 million Americans, including more than 13 million children, live in households that do not have consistent access to nutritious food. 		1 Ash Wednesday 10a Staff Meeting 5p Methodicals 5:30p Wed Night Dinner 6:30p Ash Wednesday Service 6:45p Chancel Choir 7p Children's Council	2 9a Fun & Fit. 9a Minnehaha Playdate 10a Night Discussion 2:30p Brighter Minds Music	3 9:30a Brighter Minds Music 10a Al-Anon 6:30p RCA	4 Auction 8:45a Brighter Minds Music 5p Childcare Event
5 Communion 6a Scout Pancake 9a Worship with Organ & Choir 10a Ed & Fellowship 11a Worship w/Band 6p Living Brave Women's Group 6p Youth & Conf. Classes 7p SAA 7p Vent.Crew	6 10a OA 1:30p Al-Anon 2p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Boy Scouts 6:30p Finance 6:30p Pack Meeting 6:30p UMW Leadership	7 9a Fun & Fit. 10:30a Food Shelf 1:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Toastmasters	8 International Women's Day UMW General Meeting 5p Methodicals 5:30p Wed Night Dinner 6:15p Children's Programming 6:15p Prayer Practices 6:45p Chancel Choir	9 9a Fun & Fit. 9a Minnehaha Playdate 10a Night Discussion 1p Communion @ Nokomis Sq 2:30p Brighter Minds Music	10 9:30a Brighter Minds Music 10a Al-Anon 6:30p RCA 7p Fellowship Hall reserved 7p Taizé	11 8a Church Clean Up 8:45a Brighter Minds Music
12 Daylight Saving Time Begins 9a Worship with Organ & Choir 10a Ed & Fellowship 11a Worship w/Band 4p Youth Council 6p Youth Night (grades 6-12) 6:30p Togo Church 7p Pack 1 Plan. 7p SAA	13 10a OA 1:30p Al-Anon 2p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Boy & Cub Scouts	14 9a Fun & Fit. 10:30a Food Shelf 1:30p Brighter Minds Music 6p Nokomis Prov. 6:30p Church Council	15 5p Methodicals 5:30p Wed Night Dinner 6:15p Children's Programming 6:15p Prayer Practices 6:45p Chancel Choir	16 9a Fun & Fit. 9a Minnehaha Playdate 10a Night Discussion 2:30p Brighter Minds Music	17 Newsletter items due 9:30a Brighter Minds Music 10a Al-Anon 6p Pinewood Derby setup 6:30p RCA	18 IAM Meditation 8:45a Brighter Minds Music 10:30a Pinewood Derby
19 9a Worship with Organ & Choir 10a Ed & Fellowship 11a Worship w/Band 6p Living Brave Women's Group 6p Youth & Conf. Classes 7p SAA 7p Vent. Crew	20 Spring Begins 10a OA 1:30p Al-Anon 2p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p UMW Simpson Meal Prep 6:30p Boy Scouts 6:30p Women's Soul Group	21 9a Fun & Fit. 10:30a Food Shelf 1:30p Brighter Minds Music 5:45p UMW Simpson Shelter 6:30p Toastmasters 6:30p Worship Committee	22 5p Methodicals 5:30p Wed Night Dinner 6:15p Children's Programming 6:15p Prayer Practices 6:15p Youth Meeting 6:45p Chancel Choir	23 9a Fun & Fit. 9a Minnehaha Playdate 10a Night Discussion 2:30p Brighter Minds Music	24 9a Newsletter Collation 9:30a Brighter Minds Music 10a Al-Anon 5p Mandala peace event 6:30p RCA	25 7a MinneHarvest 8:45a Brighter Minds Music
26 9a Worship with Organ & Choir 10a Ed & Fellowship 11a Worship w/Band 6p Youth & Conf. Classes 6:30p Togo Church 7p SAA	27 10a OA 1:30p Al-Anon 2p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Boy & Cub Scouts	28 9a Fun & Fit. 10:30a Food Shelf 1:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p SPR	29 5p Methodicals 5:30p Wed Night Dinner 6:15p Children's Programming 6:15p Prayer Practices 6:45p Chancel Choir	30 9a Fun & Fit. 9a Minnehaha Playdate 10a Night Discussion 2:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Trustees & B+G	31 9:30a Brighter Minds Music 10a Al-Anon 6:30p RCA	Notes: Fellowship Hall reserved for auction setup Feb 27-Mar 5

Worship in March

Lent begins on March 1, so we will spend the entire month of March in Lent. Our focus this year is prayer, so Ash Wednesday will be a plea to "hear our prayer" and then each Sunday in Lent will explore a different facet of prayer, from praying for healing to prayers of thanksgiving to prayers of confession, to how our actions are a form of prayer. We'll even explore to whom do we pray? In conjunction, there will be opportunities to explore different ways of praying on Wednesday nights. Join us as we pray through Lent!

1st	"Hear My Prayer" <i>Ash Wednesday service 6:30 pm</i>	Psalms 51:1-17
5th	"To Whom Do We Pray" <i>1st Sunday of Lent, Communion, Scouting Sunday</i>	Matthew 4:1-11
12th	"What Difference Does It Make?" <i>2nd Sunday of Lent</i>	Psalms 121
19th	"Do I Really Need to Confess Anything?" <i>3rd Sunday of Lent</i>	Romans 5:1-8
26th	"Praying for Healing" <i>4th Sunday of Lent</i>	John 9:1-41

Future Special Events at Minnehaha UMC—Save the Date

April 9 – Palm Sunday

April 13 – Maundy Thursday (service at 7:00)

April 14 – Good Friday themed Taizé service here at 7:00

Good Friday service at Richfield UMC at 7:00

April 16 – Easter! (services at 7, 9, 11)

May 7 – Bibles for 2nd graders at both worship services

May 21 – One worship service at 10:00 – Children's Musical

May 22 – 2:00 Trip to see SweetLand at the History Theatre

May 28 – One worship service at 10:00 – Memorial Day weekend

June 4 – One worship service at 10:00 – Blessing of bike helmets and picnic outside following the service

June 11 – One worship service at 10:00 – Graduation Sunday

June 18 – Outdoor worship begins at 10:30

June 20-22 – Annual Conference in St. Cloud

June 19-23 – Music and Drama Camp

June 21-23 – Vacation Bible School

Time Change

It's time to spring ahead and gain some sunlight in our mornings. Set your clocks forward one hour before coming to worship on Sunday, March 12.



Minnehaha 4th & 5th Graders deliver Valentines to Minnehaha members at Nokomis Square

All-Church Clean-Up Day on March 11



Join your Minnehaha UMC friends for an all-church clean up day on March 11 from 8:00 a.m. to 3:00 p.m. It's a family event. All ages can help clean and de-clutter the church. Join us!

Youth Ministries

March 4th – Church Auction: Youth are serving Breakfast and Lunch again this year! We will be becoming authentic baristas in the kitchen, serving all kinds of coffee treats from 10am-2pm. Breakfast is from 10-12, and lunch 12-2. Please come and join us!

March 5th – Confirmation Night: Goes from 6:00-7:30pm. The younger class will be meeting in the 3rd floor Youth room and will be working on the newest edition of "Youth News". The older class will be meeting in the Wesley Room and will be discussing Jesus Parables.

March 11th – All Church Clean-up Day: Join us for a day of de-cluttering the church! 10am-3pm

March 12th – Youth Night: Goes from 5:00-7:30pm. Back by popular demand - Youth are going to Sky Zone trampoline park! The cost is \$15.00 per youth. Have Youth to the Church a little before 5:00 pm, and please RSVP to me so I have proper transportation. Sky Zone has a special waiver that must be filled out for everyone. You can follow the link to fill one out online and send it in straight to Skyzone, or contact me and I can print one out for you to fill out.
<http://www.skyzonesports.com/Portals/0/waivers/stpaul.pdf>

****Friends are always welcome to join us! And we can still use a extra chaperone or two!****

March 18th – Youth fundraiser for Camps: Youth are serving Breakfast and Lunch this year for the Boy Scouts Pinewood Derby. We will be serving all kinds of coffee and donuts from 10am-2pm, and hamburgers and hotdogs for lunch from 12-2. The Youth (and Parents) are also encouraged to make their own Derby car to race each other after the scouts are finished. Please contact Leilani Thompson or Travis Beck for a car set if you are interested.

March 19th – Confirmation Night: Goes from 6:00-7:30pm. The younger class will be meeting in the 3rd floor Youth room and will be working on the newest edition of "Youth News". The older class will be meeting in the Wesley Room and will be discussing Jesus Miracles.

March 22nd – Sunrise Service planning night: From 6:00-7:30 in the 3rd Floor Youth room. Youth will be making plans and working on their Easter Sunrise Service project.

March 26th – Confirmation Night: Goes from 6:00-7:30pm. The younger class will be meeting in the 3rd floor Youth room and will be working on their Easter Sunrise Service project. The older class will be meeting in the Wesley Room and will be discussing Creeds.

Leilani Thompson, Director of Youth Ministries

Children's Ministries

March first marks not only the beginning of the month, and meteorological spring, this year it marks the beginning of the season of Lent. This season is forty days long (not including Sundays) and brings us up to Easter (April 16th).

Throughout the history, different traditions have been established to help Christians observe this season. Whatever the tradition, it is a time of reflection - of self and of the world. It is a time of anticipation - we see the world around us, muddy and dreary (and sometime snowy), and we wait for signs of new life, for buds on trees and the greening of grass, for bulbs to come from the ground, and the sun to feel warm. So, whatever you decide to do with your family to observe Lent, spend some of these forty days together contemplating what it means to your family to be a follower of Christ, to await and celebrate Easter morning.

Throughout the season at Minnehaha, we're focusing this year on prayer. Becky's sermons on Sunday mornings will take us through different motivations for prayer, we'll have a rotating prayer station set up in the narthex, and adult Wednesday night programming will focus on different ways to pray (I encourage you to attend the adult classes while kids have programming on second floor - from 6:15 to 7). We'll also be doing the Personal Dignity drive again, collecting items for the Food Shelf. See the Lenten flier for a schedule of what we'll be collecting.

Beyond this season, we're busy planning for summer programs - registration is now available online. We've got camps at Minnehaha (VBS and Music & Drama Camp) and camps away through Camp Minnesota. REGISTER ASAP! We also are working on Children's Sunday - preparing the musical What's Up Zak through rehearsals on Wednesday evening and during Sunday School. Children's Sunday, which marks the end of our program year, we'll be on May 21st.

As always, please let me know if you have any questions and concerns,
Jenia Strom, Director of Children & Family Ministries

Join us for 2017 Summer Programming at Minnehaha UMC

Music and Drama Camp June 19th-June 23rd

An all-day camp for children
who have completed third through eighth grade.

Campers will spend the week working on all aspects of a musical production,
which will feature the songs and stories of Sandra Boynton.



Hero Central: Discover Your Strength in God! Vacation Bible School June 21st-June 23rd

A morning program for children
in preschool through fifth grade

An opportunity for kids to grow and learn through games, arts
& crafts, music, and more. Extended afternoon daycare
available.

Summer Camps through Camp Minnesota

Overnight camps for elementary children.

Join with other children from around the Minnesota Conference for
summer camp. We'll hike, canoe, do arts and crafts, swim, have
campfires, and learn about God and the world around us.

A group will be attending Trailblazers 2 at Koronis (July 16-19) if
you'd like to attend with other Minnehaha campers. Register soon to get your space!



Questions? Contact Jenia Strom at education@minnehaha.org/612.721.6231

Register at www.minnehaha.org for VBS & Music & Drama Camp and at
www.campminnesota.org for overnight camps



Sunday, May 21, 2017 at 2:00 p.m.

Tickets: \$40.00*/ person

history theatre

30 East 10th Street, Saint Paul, MN 55101

1920. Inge Altenberg journeys to America to marry a bachelor farmer, sight unseen. But in the wake of WWI, Inge's German heritage turns her new neighbors against the match. Under cathedral skies, the determined young immigrant and her stoic farmer fight for their lives, facing their own misgivings and the harshness of an unforgiving land. A lyrical celebration of hard-won independence and a reflection of generations past, Sweet Land reminds us of who we are - and where we came from.

Join us before the performance for lunch at SAWATDEE – St. Paul, MN. There is a reservation for our group beginning at 12:00 noon. It is a short, 3 block walk to the History Theatre from the restaurant. Founder, Supeen Harrison was born near Bangkok, Thailand and opened the first Thai restaurant in the five state area in 1983.

**\$5.00 from each ticket sale will be contributed to Minnehaha United Methodist Church. Student tickets are available for \$25.00 each. Normal ticket prices are \$52 adults and \$50 senior.*

Order Tickets by April 15, 2017

Contact: Becky Sechrist or
Sue Claude (612-834-4871)

Join Other United Methodists on LGBTQ Issues

The annual gathering of the Minnesota Reconciling Congregations and Communities will be held on Saturday March 4th, 2017 at Spirit of Hope United Methodist Church in Golden Valley from 11:30 -2:00. Childcare will be provided. Please bring a potluck item to share for lunch.

- 11:30 Socializing with others from around the state
- 12:45 update on activities of the Reconciling Ministries Network in Minnesota and around the world
- 1:00 Keynote speaker, retired Bishop Melvin Talbert (who is a captivating speaker!)

Bishop Talbert is a retired United Methodist Bishop. His civil rights protest experiences impacted his life profoundly, spending three days and nights in jail with Rev. Dr. Martin Luther King, Jr. Bishop Talbert is a strong advocate for the full inclusion of all people, extending his civil rights work to the LGBTQ community. In response to the United Methodist common belief that God's grace and love is available to all persons, he asserts that the United Methodist Church is in error on the subject of "homosexuality's incompatibility with Christian teaching." He commends United Methodists to "Biblical Obedience" operating as if that negative statement does not exist, creating a church where all people are truly welcome.

A freewill offering will be taken to support the work of the Reconciling Ministries Network.

For questions, contact the Minnesota Reconciling coordinator, Kelly Dunn, 651-357-5104, kellydunn321@gmail.com or talk to Rene Cronquist or Becky Sechrist

IAM®20 Meditation Class:

Learn an effective 20 minute meditation technique for busy people

IAM®20 –Integrated Amrita Meditation®—is a meditation technique created by Mata Amritanandamayi, a world famous saint from India (www.amma.org for more info on her). In 20 minutes per day, IAM®20 promotes integration of body, mind, and spirit. Practitioners report feeling more relaxed and centered. Regular practice of IAM® lowers stress hormone (adrenaline and cortisol) levels, according to an 8 month follow up study. IAM®20 is a secular meditation which integrates easily into any spiritual or health support practice regimen. For more info about IAM®, go to www.integratedmeditation.org.

When: Saturday, March 18, 2017, from 1-4 pm

Where: Minnehaha United Methodist Church, 3701 E 50th Street, MPLS 55417

REGISTER EARLY, BRING A FRIEND: Please send name, phone number and email address to meditationiam@gmail.com or call Arun Hejmadi 719-963-5244.

Cost: No charge. Donation requested to cover expenses, overage will be donated to Amma's charities (see www.amma.org for info about charities) and Minnehaha Food Shelf.

Taizé

For some of you, the Sunday morning worship does not provide enough time for quiet, reflection, prayer and silence. We invite you to feed your soul with our monthly Taizé Service. The service is modeled after the worship services at the ecumenical community of Taizé, located in eastern France. The service has prayer, scripture, and music. The songs have few words, sung repetitively, in order to allow for deep contemplation and prayer. Join us on Friday, March 10, at 7:00 or any second Friday of the month.

Join us on Friday, February 10, at 7:00 or any second Friday of the month.



**Join us at Minnehaha for
Wednesday Night Suppers!**

Throughout the winter and spring, join us for supper from 5:30-6:30 in the Fellowship Hall.

Cost for Dinner:
\$5 for those 4 years and older
Free for children under 4
Family Cap: \$20
**PURCHASE A PUNCH CARD &
RECEIVE FOUR MEALS FREE!**

Following dinner, there is programming for children from 6:15 to 7pm.



United Methodist Women

- I believe I sent UMW news but I'll do it again: We hope everyone enjoyed seeing "Seussical Jr." as we really enjoyed putting it on. What a fun way to add funds to go to our missions. Our Circles are continuing to meet. We will be serving at Simpson on March 21 so will need servers that evening and others to help prepare the food the night before. Please let Maureen Trepp know if you are interested at 612-724-7620.
- Please save Sat., May 6 for our annual Salad Luncheon. This year it will be a Birthday Party for those members of the Greatest Generation or our Nonagenarians, no matter whether they are men or women. We will also be having our annual plant sale beginning in April and with the delivery on May 6 and 7. Hope to see you there!

Hope Hutchison Being Commissioned

If you were at our Annual Meeting in January, you voted to continue the candidacy of Hope Hutchison as a candidate for ministry. That is the last time we will take that vote, because Hope was approved by the Board of Ordained Ministry in February, and she will be commissioned on the deacon track at our Annual Conference on Wednesday evening, June 21, in St. Cloud.

We commission people as probationary members, ask them to serve for 2 years, and then consider them for full membership, ordaining them once they have been approved in that second round of examination. So, while Hope passes from our care to the care of the Board of Ordained Ministry, she will be commissioned, not ordained, this June and will need to continue to be considered again in order to be ordained. In addition, we ordain people on two different tracks. There are ordained elders, most of whom you just think of as pastors. Becky is an elder, and generally, elders serve as pastors, caring for the breadth of the work of the church. There are also ordained deacons. Deacons are specialists, and some serve in churches, focusing on an areas like Christian education or music and worship. Some serve in areas outside of the church, linking their work with the work of the church. They might be social workers, lawyers, community activists, etc. Hope is on the deacon track, and her area of focus is environmental justice. She is hoping to find a job in the community related to environmental work (like urban gardening), and make connections to local congregations through that. First, though, she has to graduate from seminary (which will take place in May). In the June newsletter, we'll have more details on how to get to her commissioning, but you can set aside the date now if you'd like to come up to St. Cloud.

Prayer in Lent

This year during Lent (the 6-week period of preparation before Easter), we'll be focusing on prayer. In addition to that being the sermon focus each week, we'll be exploring different prayer practices on Wednesday evenings from 6:15-7:00 p.m.

- March 8: Praying in color – join us as drawing, coloring, doodling are transformed into a prayer practice
- March 15: Labyrinth – We'll have the large labyrinth set up in the gym for people to walk along with some background and informational material on how to walk the labyrinth as a prayer practice. There will also be paper labyrinths to utilize for those who would rather "walk" by tracing with their fingers.
- March 22: News – Transform reading/listening to the news from aggravation or frustration into prayer.
- March 29: Body and breath – Prayer comes from our whole bodies, so we'll explore how to use our bodies and the ways we breathe into a form of prayer.
- April 5: Neighborhood walk – Grab your walking shoes as we walk through our neighborhood and pray for our neighbors and our community.

Monthly Communion at Nokomis Square

On the second Thursday of the month at 1:00 p.m., Becky offers a brief communion service at Nokomis Square preceded by a discussion of the chapter we are reading for the week in *We Make The Road By Walking*. Anyone is welcome to come. This month we will be gathering on March 9.

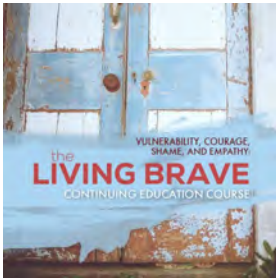
Living Brave

We are starting a new women's group to go on a Brene Brown adventure as we strive to show up, be seen, and live brave in our daily lives. This is intended for any and all women at Minnehaha UMC. Marisa Zimmerman will lead us using lessons and videos from the Living Brave continuing education course (if you are a social work or counseling professional, you will need to purchase the course yourself to get the CEU's).

This is a series of 7 sessions so we would like folks to commit to as much as possible to get the most out of the class. We will meet from 6-7:30 in the choir room at Minnehaha (2nd floor, in the corner). Please bring a journal and whatever writing utensils you prefer. It would be helpful but not required to read Brene Brown's books, *Daring Greatly* and *Rising Strong*. The course will reference these books, but no pressure to read them if you haven't.

Please RSVP on Facebook. Or if you aren't on Facebook, talk to Gail Minehart 612-237-5935. Hope to see you there!

March 5
March 19
April 9
April 23
May 7
May 21
June 4



Holy Week Services

Holy Week is observed during the last week of Lent, between Palm Sunday (April 9) and Easter Sunday (April 16). It is traditionally a time to remember Jesus' entry into Jerusalem, his last supper with the disciples, and his arrest, trial and death. We'll be offering a Maundy Thursday service in the sanctuary with communion at 7:00. We will also have a Good Friday service, which falls on the same date as our April Taizé Service. It will also start at 7:00 and will include 14 readings from the gospel of Matthew about the events leading up to Jesus' death, and there will be some singing of Taizé hymns as well as times of silence.

In addition, the sanctuary will be open on Good Friday between 9:00 and 5:00 for anyone who would like to engage in some silent contemplation. There is a centuries-old tradition of observing Stations of the Cross with words or artwork signifying important stops on Jesus' journey to the cross. Utilizing artwork by DeGrazia, we will have stations set up in the sanctuary.

AUCTION

Saturday, March 4



Coffee & Doughnuts:

10 AM – 12 Noon

Auction Preview:

10 AM

AUCTION STARTS:

11:01 AM

Lunch Served:

12 Noon – 1:30 PM

Note: All items must be removed from the church property by 5 PM on March 4. **Saturday, 3/4 only:** \$25 delivery fee for purchased items within a 10 mile radius of Minnehaha United Methodist Church.

**Cabinets, desks, collectibles, housewares,
furniture, antiques, gift certificates, food, crafts,
electronics, kid stuff: toys, books, more!**

Minnehaha United Methodist Church

3701 East 50th Street | Minneapolis, MN | 612-721-6231 | www.minnehaha.org

What Would Jesus Do?

Elie Wiesel wrote a memoir, *Night*, in 1958 in Yiddish. It was translated into French and English, and most recently revised and translated by his wife in 2006. It details in graphic detail the horrific events of a Jewish youth in a concentration camp. The book is short; the account, a lesson of something that should never happen ever again. For this writing and others, Wiesel received the Nobel Peace Prize in 1986.

This book, focused on the efforts of the Nazis to destroy the Jewish population seems an unlikely book for discussion in Lent, but in Lent, Christians face a darkness, so perhaps this writing is pertinent for the season. In addition, human rights are threatened and people killed in spite of the lessons of history.

For those of you who would want to discuss Wiesel's book in connection with our own faith, I invite you to join this 4-week session 10:00 am on Thursdays in Lent starting March 2. You can find the book at local libraries, your own bookshelves, or on the internet. Please let me know.

Judy Durfey (651-290-0568)

Ash Wednesday

Lent begins on Wednesday, March 1 this year, and we will be starting our Lenten observance with an Ash Wednesday service at 6:30 p.m. If you've never been to an Ash Wednesday service before, this is a more solemn service that includes ashes made from the burning of palms from last year's Palm Sunday. We "impose" the ashes as a reminder of how sometimes even our best intentions can go awry, and as a reminder of our own mortality. All ages are invited to participate in the service. There will be a dinner from 5:30-6:15 that same evening, and the rest of our Lenten programming will begin the following Wednesday (March 8).

Healing, Wholeness, Holiness

Dr. Shelly Rambo will be the keynote speaker at Hamline College's Mahle Symposium on Progressive Christian Thought. In addition to Dr. Rambo, there will be a variety of speakers throughout the two-day symposium on "Healing, Wholeness, Holiness: Religion Responses to Trauma and Illness." March 6-7. The schedule of speakers is below. For more information, and to register for these free workshops, go to www.hamline.edu/offices/wesley/religion-spirituality/mahle-lectures/spring-2016/ (I know it says 2016, but the link will take you to the 2017 schedule).

March 6 4:30-6:00 Dr. Monica A. Coleman, Claremont School of Theology, "Bipolar Faith: A Black Woman's Journey with Depression and Faith"

- March 7 11:30-12:45 "Jewish Perspectives on Healing"
- March 7 1:15-2:30 Rabbi Eric Weiss and Dr. Shelly Rambo
- March 7 2:45-4:00 "In Praise of Lament"
- March 7 4:15-5:15 "Re-imagining Healing"

March 7 7:00 Keynote address, Dr. Shelly Rambo, Associate Professor of Theology at Boston University School of Theology, "Resurrection in the Afterlife of Trauma: Making Sense of the Wounds that Mark Us"

New Directories

We are planning to have new directories available for Easter. Please send any address, phone, or email changes to Heather at office@minnehaha.org, and watch for a draft version on a Sunday morning in late March for you to check/correct your entry.

Boy Scout Troop 1



Pancake Breakfast Fundraiser

Sunday, March 5
8:30-11 am

Minnehaha United Methodist Church
3701 East 50th St.

\$5 PER PERSON OR \$20 PER FAMILY



Prepared. For Life.™

Purchase tickets at the door or in advance from a Troop 1 family. All proceeds support the Scouts of Boy Scout Troop 1.



Saying Yes



Six years ago, I fell on the ice (while out walking my dog, of course), and broke my ankle on the day after Ash Wednesday. Until Maundy Thursday, I was on crutches. I disliked pretty much every moment of my Lent that year. Crutches made me move slower, and my arms would get tired quickly. It was hard to stand on one leg for extended periods of time. I couldn't both open a door and go through it. I also couldn't carry anything in my hands from one place to another, and although I used a backpack, some things just don't work in a backpack (like a mug of tea). The hardest thing for me that entire Lent was asking for help. And I needed help for everything.

This year at Annual Conference, Valerie Mayer and I were sitting at a table listening to our guest speaker (Sara Miles). She talked about a Lenten practice she decided on one year – the practice of accepting help. As soon as she began describing this practice (and how hard it was), Valerie turned to me and said, “Can we do that this Lent?!” So, Valerie and I want to recommend a Lenten practice to you this year. The way Sara Miles described it was the practice of saying “yes.” When someone asks if they can do something, you say yes. If someone asks if they can help, you say yes. Sara Miles was setting up a food ministry at her church, and even though that required a lot of help from others, she still found it hard to say yes to people. All during Lent, she responded, “yes.” Yes, they could help her set up tables. Yes, they could go with her to speak to the leadership of the church. Yes, she would like help putting vegetables in boxes. Yes, please pray for the work she was doing. Yes.

We are exploring the breadth and depth of prayer this year for Lent. One of the purposes of prayer is to open us more fully to where God is guiding us, making us more able to say, “yes” to God. Saying “yes” to one another might help us on that journey. In addition, saying “yes” to one another help us to be community together. That Lent I was on crutches, I ground my teeth at having to both ask for and accept help. I wanted to be able to do it all for myself, but I had to accept help. Members of my community offered to get my lunch from the microwave to the table so I could eat. Members of my community opened doors for me. Members of my community put a chair for me in the front of the sanctuary so I could sit while I preached. Members of my community drove me close to the doors when dropping me off somewhere. I was never so glad to be given the ok to bear weight on my ankle that Maundy Thursday and cast my crutches aside. But those who had been helping me were a little disappointed. I could see it on their faces. They had enjoyed being part of my community, and they had valued their role for every “yes” I had uttered.

We are all part of a community, and we are strongest when we work together as community. So, try a Lenten practice of saying “yes.” Let the others in your community be part of community. Accept help. Agree to be part of something bigger. Try a new thing if you are asked to consider it. Let someone else do something the way they would do it (rather than the way you might do it). Practice saying yes for the next 6 weeks. You can toss your crutches away after Easter and go back to “no, thanks, I’ve got it.” But try it for a season and see what happens when you open yourself up to God and to your communities.

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In joy,
Becky



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3/17



Exploring Prayer

Lent 2017
at Minnehaha United Methodist Church

A season of reflection, study, and giving - of
growing closer to God.



Sermon Series: Why Do We Pray?

Worship at 9 and 11am on Sundays

Faith Formation at 10:15am

Wednesday Evenings:

- All-Church Dinners from 5:30 to 6:15pm
- Programming for Children (through fifth grade) - 6:15 to 7:00pm
- Programming for Youth (sixth through twelfth grade) - 6:15-7:00pm
- Adult Lenten Study: Different Ways to Pray - 6:15-7:00pm

Thursday Mornings - March 2nd, 9th, 16th, and 24th

Book Study on Elie Wiesel's *Night* at 10am.

Lenten Personal Dignity Drive for the Minnehaha Food Shelf

Consider bringing the following items with you to worship, or dropping them off at Minnehaha any time throughout the season.

March 5th-11th: Toothpaste and Toothbrushes

March 12th-18th: Toilet Paper

March 19th-25th: Soap - Bar Soap, Shampoo, and Conditioner March 26th-April 1st: Deoderant, Razors, and Shaving Cream

April 2nd-8th: Feminine Hygiene Products & Newborn-Sized Diapers

Palm Sunday, April 9th: Coats

Holy Week at Minnehaha

Palm Sunday - April 9th

Worship at 9 and 11am - Children are invited to join in the Palm Processional, and the Cherub Choir will be singing at both services

Maundy Thursday - April 13th

Worship with Communion at 7pm

Good Friday - April 14th

The sanctuary will be opened for contemplation and Stations of the Cross from 9am-5pm

Tenebrae/Taize Worship at 7pm

Easter Sunday - April 16th

Sunrise Service at 7am; Breakfast served from 8-9am; Worship with organ, choir, Hallelujah Chorus & Children's Choir at 9am; Breakfast, Easter Egg Hunt & Easter Crafts from 10-11am; Worship with band & Children's Choir at 11am

